

AI Operations & Chief-of-Staff — Practical Assignment

Early-stage health & human-physiology AI startup

Time box: ~5 hours (please don't exceed 6). • **Paid:** invoice us for your time regardless of outcome.
Submit: one shared folder (Notion or Google Drive) with all written work, code/links, and the Loom videos requested per task.

Why this exists. It mirrors the real job: take scattered, ambiguous input and turn it into a plan, a working tool, or a clear decision — and communicate it well. We care far more about **judgment, resourcefulness, and fluency with AI tools** than polish. Make reasonable assumptions, state them, and keep moving. Please don't email us asking for "the right answer" — how you handle ambiguity is part of what we're evaluating.

Tools & access — read first. You do **not** need any of our company accounts and should not spend your own money. Use free personal tools. For anything you can't reach (a paid API, a service login), **stub it** and say so — e.g. write output to a CSV / Google Sheet / markdown file instead of a live Slack or Linear. We grade the logic, not the integration. The raw input you need is attached as **Appendix A** (flight brief).

Task 1 — Plan: how you'd build a company "second brain" strategy

The founder keeps everything in their head; the company is scattered, with a North Star that changes monthly and meetings that get recorded but never reviewed. Write a clear plan (1–2 pages) for how you would build the company's **second brain** — one trusted system where knowledge, decisions, goals, and tasks are captured, organized, and easy to retrieve. Address at minimum:

- **Capture** — how information gets in (meetings, notes, email, chat) with minimal friction.
- **Organize** — your proposed structure/taxonomy, and *why* (note: the company runs two product lines — a consumer "high-performance" product and a clinical product — so the system has to keep both straight).
- **Retrieve** — how someone gets an answer in 10 seconds three months later, and where AI (search/summarization) fits.
- **Maintain** — what stops it from rotting: rituals, ownership, archiving.
- **Rollout** — a realistic first-30-days sequence to stand it up without overwhelming the team.

Deliver: a 1–2 page written plan. A simple diagram of the structure is a plus.

Task 2 — Build a tool: the best flights for a trip build

Build a tool that takes a trip brief (see **Appendix A**) and returns the best itinerary. This is a real, multi-city trip with constraints that **deliberately conflict** — so a "find the cheapest flight" script will fail. Your tool must encode a scoring function that trades off price, total travel time, red-eyes, layover rules, airline preference, and hard timing constraints, then justify its pick.

- Pull live fare data if you can reach it. If not, state your data approach and use realistic sample fares — but the **scoring/selection logic must be real and reusable** for a different brief.
- Output: one recommended end-to-end itinerary (all legs, times, layovers, fare class, total price + total travel time), a ranked runner-up with one-line reasoning, any constraint you couldn't satisfy, and a clear view of how you weighted the tradeoffs.

Deliver: the working tool (code/repo or workflow) + a 2–3 min Loom running it on the Appendix A brief and explaining your scoring logic.

Task 3 — Build a live dashboard on public data build

Build a **live** dashboard or tool that pulls from a public data source and turns it into something useful — it must fetch fresh data when opened/run (not a static screenshot of numbers you pasted in). Because we're a clinical/physiology company, a strong, on-theme choice is the **ClinicalTrials.gov API** (free, no key) — e.g. a dashboard tracking active trials in a space like sepsis, ICU monitoring, or remote patient monitoring: counts over time, by phase, by sponsor, recently updated, etc. Other genuinely-public sources (CDC, data.gov, Our World in Data, an open finance/weather API) are fine if you'd rather.

- Must actually call the source live and handle the response (pagination, missing fields, errors).
- Show judgment about *what's worth showing* — don't just dump the raw API. A couple of clear, decision-useful views beat twenty noisy ones.
- Deploy it somewhere we can open it (a hosted link) if you can; if not, give us a repo + a 1-line run command.

Deliver: a live link or runnable repo + a 2–3 min Loom showing it pulling fresh data and walking through what you chose to surface and why.

How we score it

Area	Weight	What "great" looks like
Second-brain plan (Task 1)	25%	A system we could actually run on; sound structure; handles the two product lines; realistic rollout
Flight tool (Task 2)	35%	Real scoring logic that honors the hard constraints and trades off the soft ones; defensible pick; reusable

Live dashboard (Task 3)	30%	Genuinely live data; handles real API messiness; smart choices about what to surface
Communication & ownership (Looms + overall)	10%	Clear spoken & written English; stated assumptions; surfaced things we didn't ask for

What we are NOT looking for: perfectionism or waiting on us for direction. A rough tool that runs beats a polished one that doesn't. Time-box yourself, and tell us what you'd do next if you had more time.

Appendix A — Flight brief (raw input for Task 2)

Trip request from the founder. Build a tool that takes a brief like this and returns the best itinerary.

TRAVELER: the founder (1 passenger)

HOME AIRPORT: San Francisco (SFO). OAK or SJC acceptable only if clearly better than SFO.

MULTI-CITY TRIP, next month (July):

Leg 1 - SFO -> Boston (BOS)

Depart: Mon Jul 13

HARD CONSTRAINT: must land in Boston no later than 5:00pm local
(7:00pm dinner with the pilot partner that cannot be missed).

Leg 2 - Boston (BOS) -> New York (JFK or LGA; EWR acceptable)

Travel: Wed Jul 15, after 3:00pm (summit ends 2:00pm; needs ~1hr to reach the airport).

Must be in NYC by end of day Jul 15.

Leg 3 - New York -> SFO (home)

Depart: Fri Jul 17

PREFERENCES: not a red-eye; must land at SFO before midnight Jul 17.

PREFERENCES & SCORING (these intentionally conflict - the tool must trade them off):

- Budget: keep TOTAL airfare under \$1,500 if possible.
BUT will pay up to \$400 more to avoid a red-eye OR to save 3+ hours of total travel time.
- Nonstop strongly preferred. A connection is OK only if it saves >\$250 or is the only option.
- Layovers: none shorter than 45 min or longer than 2.5 hrs.
- Airline: mild preference for United / partners (founder has status) - small bonus, NOT a hard rule.
- Fare class: NO basic economy (wants seat assignment + to keep miles).
- Bags: carry-on only. Seat: aisle preferred. Dislikes departures before 7:00am.

OUTPUT EXPECTED:

1. One recommended end-to-end itinerary (all 3 legs): airline, flight #s, times, layovers, fare class, TOTAL price + TOTAL travel time.
2. A ranked runner-up + one sentence on why the recommendation beat it.
3. Any constraint that couldn't be satisfied + the tradeoff made.
4. Your scoring logic (how price / time / red-eye / airline preference were weighted).